

Cardstock & Scrap Sorting Guide

A clean, printable guide outlining the best methods for sorting full sheets of cardstock and organizing paper scraps. Designed for binders, craft rooms, classes, and sharing.

Cardstock Sorting Key Points

1. Sort by Color Family

- Neutrals: white, black, cream, kraft
- Warm colors: red, orange, yellow
- Cool colors: green, blue, purple
- Specialty: metallic, glitter, vellum, textured

Why it works: Color is the fastest way to match photos and themes.

2. Sort by Shade or Tone

- Light / Medium / Dark
- Bright / Muted / Pastel
- Patterned vs. solid (optional)

Why it works: Keeps your stash visually consistent and easy to mix.

3. Sort by Weight or Texture (optional)

- 65 lb (lightweight)
- 80 lb (standard)
- 110 lb (heavyweight)
- Textured: linen, canvas, embossed

Why it works: Helpful for Cricut cutting, cardmaking, and mixed media.

4. Keep Specialty Cardstock Separate

- Glitter
- Foil
- Vellum
- Acetate
- Pre-scored card bases
- Holiday or themed packs

Why it works: Specialty papers store better and stay protected.

5. Store Upright for Easy Browsing

- 12×12 vertical holders
- Magazine-style bins
- Open shelves with dividers
- Hanging file folders

Why it works: Flip-through access is fast and satisfying.

6. Label Everything Clearly

- Color labels
- Alphabetical labels
- Divider tabs
- Category cards

Why it works: Makes the system easy to maintain.

Scrap Storage Key Points

1. Sort Scraps by Size

- **Large scraps:** 6×12, 8×8, half sheets
- **Medium scraps:** 4×6, 3×4, card-front size
- **Small scraps:** strips, squares, tiny pieces

Why it works: You instantly know what's usable for mats, punches, or backgrounds.

2. Sort by Color Family

- Neutrals
- Warm colors
- Cool colors
- Specialty scraps (glitter, foil, vellum)

Why it works: Grab a color and go.

3. Use Clear, Open Containers

- 6×8 zipper pouches
- Iris photo boxes
- Clear drawer units
- Magazine holders with envelopes
- Zip-top bags inside a bin

Why it works: Visibility = usability.

4. Keep Scraps Near Your Workspace

Why it works: You'll use them more when they're within reach.

5. Create a "Use First" Scrap Bin

Great for:

- Odd shapes
- Branding strips
- Leftover die cuts
- Tiny pieces you want to use up

Why it works: Encourages creativity and reduces waste.

6. Set a Scrap Rule

Choose one:

- Nothing smaller than 2×2
- Strips must be at least 6 inches long
- If it doesn't fit in the bin, toss it
- Review scraps once a month

Why it works: Keeps the system from overflowing.

7. Store Scraps With Matching Paper (optional)

- Use 12×12 pockets
- Slide scraps behind full sheets
- Label the pocket

Why it works: Everything stays together.

8. Keep a Scrap Inspiration Sheet Nearby

Ideas include:

- Strips
- Tags
- Banners
- Circles
- Frames
- Clusters
- Mats
- Sunbursts
- Quilts

Why it works: Inspiration leads to action.

This printable guide is ready to use in your craft room, binder, or website.